

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02351

CASE NAME: SANDRA HERNANDEZ VS. NFP CORPORATE SERVICES (CA), INC.

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: EXTENSION OF TIME TO OBTAIN A DEFAULT JUDGMENT**

FILED BY: NFP CORPORATE SERVICES (CA), INC.

TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendants and cross-complainants NFP Corporate Services (CA), Inc. and NFP CA Insurance Services, Inc. ("NFP Defendants") filed a Motion for an Extension of Time to Obtain a Default Judgment against Cross-Defendants on March 11, 2026 (the "Motion for Extension of Time"). The Motion for Extension of Time was set for hearing on August 3, 2026.

Background

The NFP Defendants filed a Cross-Complaint against Corbin Blume and Jaguar Energy, LLC (the "Cross-Defendants") on January 8, 2026. See Cross-Complaint filed January 8, 2026; see Declaration of Brittany Rogers filed March 11, 2026 ("Rogers Decl."), ¶4 and **Exhibit 2** thereto. The Cross-Complaint was served on the Cross-Defendants. *Id.* at ¶¶5-7.

Defaults were entered against the Cross-Defendants on February 17, 2026. *Id.* at ¶8.

Analysis

The NFP Defendants seek an order extending the deadline to seek and obtain entry of a default judgment against the defaulted Cross-Defendants, pursuant to Rule 3.110 of the California Rules of Court (CRC). See CRC 3.110(h) ("When a default is entered, the party who requested the entry of default must obtain a default judgment against the defaulting party within 45 days after the default was entered, unless the court has granted an extension of time.").

The motion is unopposed.

The Court notes that there is now pending a separate Cross-Complaint against the same Cross-Defendants by defendant and cross-complainant Theodore Zouzounis.

Disposition

The Court finds and rules as follows:

1. The Motion for Extension of Time is GRANTED.
2. The Court shall enter the proposed order lodged with the moving papers.

5. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02589

CASE NAME: MICHAEL HOFFMAN VS. PETER DOCTER

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: MONETARY SANCTIONS**

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff Michael Hoffman ("Plaintiff") filed eleven separate discovery motions on September 29 and 30, 2025 to compel further responses to various discovery requests propounded upon the defendants.

Collectively, these motions are referred to herein as the “Motions to Compel Further Responses.” The Motions to Compel Further Responses were set for hearing on various dates and consolidated for hearing on the March 23, 2026 calendar by the Court. See Order entered February 19, 2026. The Motions to Compel Further Responses were heard on March 23, 2026 and May 18, 2026. See Order entered April 1, 2026 and Order entered June 4, 2026. The Court ruled on the discovery matters at issue. *Id.*

The Court found that the unsuccessful moving party engaged in conduct that constituted misuse of the discovery process and that warranted the imposition of monetary sanctions (the “Monetary Sanctions”). See Order entered June 4, 2026.

A briefing schedule was set for submission of further papers regarding the amount of the Monetary Sanctions and a further hearing was set on August 3, 2026.

Analysis

Defendants’ supplemental declaration regarding Monetary Sanctions was filed on June 17, 2026. See Declaration of Ondrej Likar filed June 17, 2026 (“Likar Decl.”). The declaration summarizes scope of the work performed in connection with litigating the Motions to Compel Further Responses and the billing rates for the various timekeepers doing that work. *Id.* at ¶3 *et seq.* Billing records were proffered as well. *Id.* at Exhibits B through E.

In total, defendants’ supplemental declaration reflects \$31,710.00 in total fees incurred in litigating the Motions to Compel Further Responses. Those sums are less than the actual fees incurred, as certain further expenses such as 14.9 hours of paralegal time were left out in a voluntary effort to mitigate the claimed expenses, consistent with the Court’s expressed inclination to mitigate the imposed Monetary Sanctions in light of the totality of the circumstances. See *Id.* at ¶¶7-18 and 20-24. Defendants have indicated that they are only seeking \$27,000.00 (\$6,000.00, \$10,000.00, \$8,000.00 and \$3,000.00 for the various categories of work outlined in the Likar Decl.).

Plaintiff filed an Opposition on July 17, 2026, along with an opposition declaration. See Declaration of Kevin Tredway filed July 17, 2026 (“Tredway Decl.”).

The Court has considered the totality of the circumstances as relates to the concerns raised by Plaintiff, among others, regarding the scope and nature of the billings and the results achieved weighed against the scope of the matters resolved through prior meet and confer efforts.

The Court concludes that Monetary Sanctions in the amount of \$12,500 are just and reasonable. In fixing said amount, the Court has considered all evidence in the record before the Court, including the further declarations submitted. The Court also mitigated the award in the exercise of its discretion and in light of the totality of the circumstances bearing on this discovery dispute, including, but not limited to, the substantial meet and confer efforts that reduced the scope of the discovery items in dispute and ultimately ruled upon by the Court.

The Court does not conclude that resolution of the setting of the amount of the Monetary Sanctions imposed by prior order is necessarily stayed by the now pending Anti-SLAPP Motion. The Court declines to exercise any discretion that it may have to do so.

Disposition

The Court further finds and orders as follows:

1. The Monetary Sanctions shall be paid by Plaintiff to defendants in the sum of **\$12,500.00** within

sixty (60) calendar days of notice of entry of this order.

2. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

6. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-01386
CASE NAME: LAUREN GLICKMAN VS. DOES 1 TO 30, INCLUSIVE
***HEARING ON MINOR'S COMPROMISE RE: ATHENA GLICKMAN**
FILED BY: GLICKMAN, LAUREN
TENTATIVE RULING:

Petitioner Lily Shirvanee, the duly appointed guardian ad litem herein, for the minor claimant Athena Glickman, filed a Petition for Approval of Compromise of Claim on or about April 24, 2026 (the "Minor's Compromise") seeking court approval of the compromise and proposed disposition set forth therein. See Code Civ. Proc. § 372 and Rule 7.950 *et seq.* of the California Rules of Court (CRC). The Minor's Compromise was set for hearing on August 3, 2025.

Analysis

The Minor's Compromise is unopposed. The Court has considered the verified Minor's Compromise and finds the proposed terms to be just and reasonable.

Disposition

The Court finds and rules as follows:

1. The Minor's Compromise is APPROVED.
2. The Court shall enter the proposed forms of order lodged with the moving papers.

7. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-01837
CASE NAME: VINCIANE BUZENET VS. HI-HVAC, INC.
***HEARING ON MOTION FOR DISCOVERY**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff Vinciane Buzenet ("Plaintiff") filed a motion to compel further responses to special interrogatories and requests for production on April 13, 2026 (the "Motion to Compel"). By the Motion to Compel, Plaintiff seeks further responses to Special Interrogatories, Set Two, and Requests for Production, Set Two (collectively, the "Discovery Requests"). The Motion to Compel was set for hearing on August 3, 2026. The motion is opposed.

Background

A case management conference ("CMC") was conducted April 30, 2026. In its CMC Order, the Court directed the parties to meet and confer regarding ongoing discovery disputes and to file a "Joint Separate Statement" addressing any unresolved disputes. See CMC Order filed May 6, 2026, ¶1.

Both parties describe meet and confer efforts on or around June 6, 2026. See Opposition, p. 3; see also Plaintiff's Reply ISO Motion to Compel filed July 20, 2026 (the "Reply"), p. 4. Defendant Hi-HVAC, INC. ("Defendant") provided supplemental responses on June 29, 2026. Reply, p. 2; Opposition, p. 2.